SEPARATE KEY

Pronunciation practice: key

These answers follow the guide's chosen reading convention. English cues identify particular sounds, not substitute spellings for whole Old English words. The permitted American **r** and practical short-vowel approximations are acceptable. Meanings and grammatical forms are supplied throughout; the tasks assess pronunciation.

A. Vowels and length

A1. for, "for"; fōr, "went". For has the short rounded **o** described in §2. **Fōr** has long **ō**: hold the steady initial vowel of *go*, without its final glide. The macron changes duration; it does not mark stress or authorize copying the vowel of the English gloss.

A2. węnde, "went"; wēnde, "thought; supposed". Short **ę** has the vowel of *bet*. Long **ē** has the steady initial vowel of *day*, held without the glide. The hook adds no separate sound. Both words have two syllables, with an audible light **e** in the second.

A3. dǣd, "deed"; wīd, "wide"; hȳdan, "hide; conceal". All three marked vowels are long. **Ǣ** has the held vowel of *cat*; **ī** has the held vowel of *see*. For **ȳ**, keep that same high front tongue position but round the lips as for **oo** in *food*. Moving the tongue back would turn it into ordinary **ū**. **Dǣd** and **wīd** have one syllable each; **hȳdan** has two. Do not substitute the diphthongs of English *wide* or *hide*.

A4. Each diphthong is one glide within one syllable. The macron lengthens its first part.

Word and supplied meaning	Diphthong and syllables
eall, all	Short **ea**: *cat* vowel toward **oo**; one syllable.
scēap, sheep	Long **ēa**: held *cat* vowel toward **oo**; one syllable.
heorte, heart	Short **eo**: steady *day*-type vowel toward **oo**; two syllables, including final **e**.
frēond, friend	Long **ēo**: held steady *day*-type vowel toward **oo**; one syllable.
scield, shield	Short **ie**: *see* vowel toward **oo**; one syllable.
gīet, yet; still	Long **īe**: held *see* vowel toward **oo**; one syllable.

Neither two vowel letters nor extra duration requires an extra syllable. Final **ll** in **eall** has ordinary single-consonant duration under the guide's convention.

B. Consonants and unfamiliar sounds

B1. cēosað, "choose". Initial **c** is **ch**, as in *chin*, before the front diphthong **ēo**. This vetted example follows the ordinary initial pattern. The following diphthong remains one long glide.

B2. micel, "large; great"; micles, a declined form. In **micel**, **c** is **ch**: it follows **i** and precedes **e**. In **micles**, it is **k**: it immediately precedes the consonant **l**. The same word can change its consonant sound when the form changes. Merely noticing the preceding **i** misses the second condition.

B3. gān, "go; walk"; glæd, "glad". Both begin with stopped **g**, as in *go*. In **gān**, the following **ā** is a back vowel. In **glæd**, the immediate neighbour is **l**, so the later **æ** does not put initial **g** immediately before a front vowel. Neither enters the **y** branch; initial position then selects the stopped sound.

B4. fæger, "beautiful; fair"; regn, "rain". Both have **g** pronounced as **y** in *yes*. It follows a front vowel, **æ** or **e**, and no back vowel immediately follows it. In **regn**, **g** comes before **n**, not after it; the stopped-**g** condition "after **n**" therefore does not apply. Do not transfer the **c**-before-consonant rule to **g**.

B5. āgan, "have; possess". Its single medial **g** lies between back vowels, so it does not enter the **y** branch. It is neither initial nor after **n** nor doubled: use continuous voiced **g**. Bring the back of the tongue near the hard-**g** position, leave a narrow gap, and let air pass with throat vibration. A complete closure gives the wrong stopped sound; omitting the sound loses a consonant.

B6. brycg, "bridge"; singan, "sing". Cg has the final consonant sound of *bridge*. **Ng** has the sequence heard in *finger*, including the stopped **g**; do not reduce it to the end of modern English *sing*. The short **y** of **brycg** uses the tongue position of *bit* with rounded lips. Combination rules take priority over single-letter rules.

B7. riht, "right; direct"; dohtor, "daughter". After front **i** in **riht**, raise the middle of the tongue toward the roof of the mouth for the front, unvoiced continuous sound. After back **o** in **dohtor**, use the back of the tongue near the **k** position. Keep a gap for breath in both; neither is an ordinary **k** stop. Both following **t** sounds are audible. **Dohtor** has two syllables and a short **o**.

B8. scūfan, "thrust"; cwæð, "said". **Sc** gives the single **sh** sound of *ship*, even before **ū**. **Cw** gives **k** followed by **w**, joined without an inserted vowel. Applying a single-**c** rule inside **sc** would wrongly produce a separate **k**.

C. Voice

C1. æfre, "ever; always". **F** is voiced, as in *van*. Its neighbours are voiced **æ** and **r**. The rule requires voiced sounds on both sides, not two vowels.

C2. fīf, "five". Both **f** sounds are unvoiced, as in *fan*: one is initial and the other final. Modern English *five* does not license a final **v** here.

C3. cēosað, "choose". Medial **s** is voiced, as in *zip*, between the voiced **ēo** glide and **a**. Final **ð** is unvoiced, as in *thin*. Decide each consonant from its own environment.

C4. hæfð, "has". Final **ð** is unvoiced, as in *thin*. The preceding **f** is next to that voiceless consonant, so it is unvoiced too, as in *fan*. The preceding vowel alone does not make **f** voiced.

C5. cwæð, "said". Final **ð** is unvoiced, as in *thin*. Writing thorn instead would not change the sound: **þ** and **ð** do not encode a voiced/unvoiced distinction. This question compares spellings; it does not authorize changing the course's edited word.

C6. hǣlðu, "health"; æfre, "ever; always". The supplied exception gives **ð** in **hǣlðu** unvoiced **th**, although **l** and **u** are voiced. In **æfre**, the ordinary rule gives voiced **f** between **æ** and **r**. A word-specific pronunciation takes priority over the default. Recognizing that limit is the task; deriving the exceptional sound from visible spelling is not required.

D. Syllables and stress

D1. sittan, "sit". Two syllables, with stress on the first. Hold the **t** closure longer before releasing into the second syllable. **I** stays short; holding **tt** neither lengthens it nor adds a vowel or syllable.

D2. sunne, "sun". Two syllables, with stress on the first. Hold medial **nn** longer, as with the **n** across *pen-knife*. Its duration adds no syllable. Keep the final light **e** audible; modern English's one-syllable *sun* is not the model for the whole word.

D3. gewrit, "letter; written document". Two syllables; stress **writ**, after unstressed **ge-**. Pronounce **w+r** without an inserted vowel. There is no doubled consonant. The vowel **i** remains short despite receiving the stress.

D4. forlǣtan, "abandon; forsake". Three syllables, with stress on **lǣ** in the root. The supplied division identifies unstressed **for-**. The macron says that **ǣ** is long; the prefix/root rule determines stress. There is no doubled consonant, and final **-tan** remains audible.

E. A sentence adapted from Cook

The supplied meaning is "God created heaven and earth." These questions apply sound rules; they do not test independent translation.

E1. gescēop, "created". Initial **g** before **e**, in the supplied prefix **ge-**, has the **y** sound of *yes*. The combination **sc** has **sh**. There are two syllables: the light prefix and stressed **scēop**, whose **ēo** is one long glide. Keep the prefix vowel; **g** and **sc** are not adjacent consonant sounds.

E2. heofonan, "heaven". F is voiced, as in *van*, between the voiced **eo** glide and **o**. There are three syllables: the first contains **eo**, and the next two contain **o** and **a**. The glide does not take two syllables; neither unstressed vowel is silent.

E3. eorðan, "earth". Ð is voiced, as in *this*, between voiced **r** and **a**. The rule is "between voiced sounds", so a voiced consonant is as relevant as a vowel. Keep the initial short **eo** glide and the audible second syllable.